

CANONICAL LESSON

Access Means Reaching Opportunity Reliably

Decision-centred foundations for accountable sector intelligence

Production Unit	PU-B07-C57
Notebook	V7_D_N07
Status	Controlled educational draft v0.1
Data boundary	Synthetic instructional data only

Central decision: Measure mobility by reliable access to opportunities across time, cost, safety, disability, gender, geography, service variability, and uncertainty—not distance alone.

Learning outcomes

Why this matters

Average travel time can hide unreliable service, inaccessible routes, unsafe transfers, and unequal opportunity.

The analytical workflow is useful only when evidence, uncertainty, authority, and action are connected explicitly. The model supports professional judgement; it does not replace accountable institutional authority.

Worked cross-sector example

A city compares actual travel reliability and affordability to jobs, schools, health care, and markets across neighbourhoods.

Boundary: The example supports learning and review. It does not constitute an official statistic, eligibility determination, enforcement action, clinical judgement, or operational authorization.

Practice and reflection

- 1.
- Add multiple destinations.
- 2.

- Include disability access.
- 3.
- Explain why a short distance may still mean poor access.

Answer key

- 1.
- Compute opportunity-specific cumulative or gravity measures with service hours.
- 2.
- Audit vehicles, stops, paths, information, assistance, and destination accessibility.
- 3.
- Cost, waiting, transfers, safety, reliability, congestion, barriers, and opening hours can dominate distance.

Operational readiness checklist

- Purpose and decision owner are named.
- Evidence definitions, provenance, and lawful access are documented.
- Uncertainty and abstention are visible.
- Human review, escalation, monitoring, incident response, and retirement are assigned.
- Equity, accessibility, security, and sector-specific approval are complete.